

Tunisia, audited — what the state is asked, and what it receives

Cooperation, not money. Nine legs, six gates, one scoreboard — every gate a public number the state can check.

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1. What the state is asked for — cooperation, not money

ASK	INSTRUMENT	COST TO THE TREASURY
Access to GCT’s wet-process acid stream	MOU + sampling agreement	zero
Municipal/industrial water offtake under SONEDE’s existing regime	tariff contract ($\geq \$0.68/\text{m}^3$ gate)	zero — the tariff clears the cost
Solar under the existing IPP concession regime (STEG 25-yr PPA)	tender participation	zero
40-year state-domain land leases (Law 93-120)	leases already provided by law	zero
Health-fund legal structure	registration	zero

2. What the state receives

External account: ~\$285M/yr of exports + import substitution + financing delta at full phase — measured against the 26.2% of export revenues that debt service takes today. **Rating path:** B-/Caa1 → BB- and reserves 4.5 → 6+ months as the owned-export engines compound (Rc11). **Health scoreboard:** the basin’s water chemistry, DALY ledger and filter uptime become public KPIs — the collateral that lowers the price of every loan. **Jobs:** workshop, nursery, ponds, plants, solar crews, health workers — in the towns where the 2008 and 2015 blockades began. A job is the cheapest peace treaty ever signed.

3. The gates are public — the state sees every number

MODULE	GATE	PASSES ON
Health pilot (100 households, 2 schools, 90 days)	filter uptime $\geq 70\%$, urinary F $\downarrow 20\%$	public KPIs
Metals pilot	U recovery $\geq 85\%$, all-in $\leq \$75/\text{lb}$, offtake signed	GCT stream
Solar	DSCR ≥ 1.15 inside the bankable region, or grant support	PPA award

MODULE	GATE	PASSES ON
Desalination	≥60% contracted offtake, blended ≥\$0.68/m ³	brine permit
Terfas	3-season record ≥200 kg/ha at ≥€20/kg; quota clause signed	scaling toward 2,000-3,000 ha

4. Phase 0 — what the 90 days produce for the state

Two anchor measurements — the 100-point water panel and the acid-stream assays (\$75k of the \$253k list) — plus the emissions inventory. Every projection on this page becomes a signed number before one brick is laid. Nothing is asked of the state beyond cooperation, and every gate is a number the state can check.

What this document is: a concept-level engineering design whose numbers are computed in code from sourced primitives — recomputed, corrected, and applied into the design. Free and public.

What it is not: a commissioned state program, a bank-grade feasibility study, an investment offer, or a claim that any of this has been built. Nothing here is advice to any government or any investor. Nothing replaces geological, radiological, geotechnical or EPC-level surveys. Verify every figure and citation before relying on any of it.

Works cited

- [Rm17] GCT throughput (~6.5 Mt phosphate rock/yr; >10 Mt/yr PG at peak; 'hundreds of millions of tons' discharged at Gabès) — http://www.gct.com.tn/fileadmin/user_upload/Downloads/Rapport_Annuels/GCT-ANNUAL-REPORT-2012-PART1.pdf..
- [Rw7] Tunisian water tariffs: SONEDE 0.200-2.310 TND/m³; irrigation 0.060-0.160 TND/m³; groundwater 0.112-0.162 TND/m³ — <https://www.sonede.com.tn/tout-savoir-sur-leau/la-facture-deau-methodes-de-paiement/>...
- [Rw10] Tunisia grid: STEG 5.9 GW, ~19 TWh/yr, 95% gas-fired, renewables <5%, industrial tariff 0.352 TND/kWh; budget deficit 5-7% GDP, debt ~83% GDP — <https://www.trade.gov/country-commercial-guides/tunisia-electrical-power-systems-and-renewable-energy...>
- [Rw12] Tunisia land law: foreign ownership of agricultural land prohibited; 40-year leases only; state-domain conversion is an administrative hurdle — <https://2009-2017.state.gov/e/eb/efd/2008/101021.htm...>
- [Rc11] Tunisia sovereign ratings: Moody's Caa1 (Feb 2025 upgrade, stable); Fitch B- (Sep 2025, affirmed Jan 2026); reserves ~4.5 months im port cover; WACC 10-15% — <https://www.fitchratings.com/research/sovereigns/fitch-upgrades-tunisia-to-b-outlook-stable-12-09-2025...>
- [Rc12] Who finances Tunisia: EIB, AfDB, KfW, World Bank/IFC, EU Global Gateway (17 GW renewable programme); no active IMF program — <https://international-partnerships.ec.europa.eu/policies/global-gateway/17-gw-renewable-energy-programme-tunis...>
- [Rc13] Empirical IPP record: 500 MW solar awarded 2024/25 (Scatec, Qair, Voltalia 25-yr PPAs at ~\$0.031/kWh); installed renewables ~40 0 MW; STEG debt >\$1.3B — <https://www.engineeringnews.co.za/article/scatec-awarded-ppas-for-wind-solar-projects-in-tunisia-2026-01-26...>
- [Rc19] Tunisia arid land: ~86,000 ha of state domain earmarked for 40-year agricultural leases (Law 93-120) — <https://documents1.worldbank.org/curated/en/926441468778187741/pdf/multiopage.pdf...>
- [Ru2] URANEXT/OCP (Morocco) building the first modern yellowcake-from-phosphoric-acid plant, ~\$100M CAPEX, El Jadida, 2025 — <https://northafricapost.com/87963-uranext-to-build-moroccos-first-yellowcake-uranium-plant-in-el-jadida.html...>